

Travel & Reimbursement Policy

Guidelines for business travel expenses and reimbursement procedures

Version:	v2.5	Effective Date:	January 1, 2024
Department:	Human Resources	Applies To:	All Employees

1. Purpose

This policy provides clear guidelines on what business travel expenses are reimbursable, the limits for each category, and the procedure for claiming reimbursements. The company will reimburse all reasonable and necessary expenses incurred during approved business travel.

2. Travel Authorization

- All travel must be pre-approved before booking through the HR portal
- Domestic travel: Manager approval required
- International travel: Manager + VP + Finance approval required
- Emergency travel: Verbal approval followed by written approval within 24 hours
- Unapproved travel expenses will not be reimbursed

3. Domestic Travel Limits

Grade	Daily Allowance	Hotel (per night)	Air Travel	Train Travel
Junior (L1-L3)	Rs. 800	Rs. 2,500	Economy	2nd AC
Senior (L4-L6)	Rs. 1,200	Rs. 4,000	Economy	1st AC
Manager (L7-L9)	Rs. 1,800	Rs. 6,000	Economy/Flexi	1st AC
VP and above	Rs. 2,500	Rs. 10,000	Business Class	1st AC

4. International Travel Limits

Grade	Daily Allowance (USD)	Hotel (per night USD)	Air Travel
Junior (L1-L3)	\$60	\$120	Economy
Senior (L4-L6)	\$90	\$180	Economy
Manager (L7-L9)	\$130	\$250	Economy/Premium Economy
VP and above	\$200	\$400	Business Class

5. Reimbursable Expenses

5.1 Transportation

- Flight tickets (economy class as per grade) — book 14+ days in advance when possible
- Train tickets as per grade entitlement
- Airport taxi/cab to and from office/hotel (actual, with receipt)
- Local transport during business travel (auto, cab, metro) — actuals up to Rs. 500/day domestic
- Toll charges and parking during official duty — actuals with receipt

5.2 Accommodation

- Hotel within approved limits as per grade
- Company guest house (if available) — preferred option
- Airbnb or serviced apartments allowed if cost is lower than hotel limit
- Single occupancy only — no personal guests

5.3 Meals

- Meals during travel are covered up to the daily allowance limit
- Alcohol is not reimbursable under any circumstances
- Client entertainment meals: up to Rs. 3,000 per person with prior approval

5.4 Communication

- International roaming charges: up to Rs. 2,000 per trip
- Local SIM for international travel: actuals
- Internet charges at hotel: actuals (included in hotel bill)

6. Non-Reimbursable Expenses

- Personal entertainment (movies, sightseeing, personal shopping)
- Alcohol or tobacco products
- Laundry (unless travel exceeds 7 consecutive days)
- Traffic fines or penalties
- Expenses for spouse, family, or personal guests
- Upgrades beyond approved class without prior written approval
- Expenses without valid receipts above Rs. 200

7. Reimbursement Procedure

- Submit expense claim within 15 days of returning from travel
- Use the Expense Report form on HR portal (hr.acme.com/expenses)
- Attach all original receipts or digital copies for expenses above Rs. 200
- Manager must approve within 5 business days
- Finance processes approved claims within 10 business days
- Reimbursement credited directly to salary account

Note: Claims submitted after 30 days of travel completion will not be processed without VP approval.

8. Travel Advances

Employees may request a travel advance of up to 80% of estimated travel expenses. Advances must be applied for at least 5 days before travel. Unused advance must be returned within 5 business days of return. Outstanding advances will be deducted from salary if not settled within 30 days.